

Zixin Wang

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Usable privacy and security; human-AI interaction; privacy in LLM applications; AI adoption and trust.

RESEARCH PROFILE

My research studies how people understand, negotiate, and protect their privacy as AI systems and connected devices enter everyday settings. I combine large-scale surveys and experiments with statistical modeling to identify what users need to make informed privacy decisions, and translate those findings into design mechanisms for privacy negotiation and disclosure. My recent work focuses on privacy leakage in LLM applications and on how users weigh privacy, trust, and utility when adopting AI assistants; findings have informed platform policy recommendations for short-term rental and smart home privacy.

SKILLS

- **Methods:** Randomized online experiments (factorial and vignette designs), large-scale surveys, scale development and validation, interviews and in-situ studies, thematic analysis, human evaluation of LLM outputs
- **Statistics:** Regression, ANOVA, GLM/GLMM, mixed-effects models, power analysis, effect sizes, reliability and validity testing
- **Tools:** R, Python, SQL, Qualtrics, Prolific, Git

EDUCATION

University of Michigan, School of Information

Ph.D. in Information Science, advised by Florian Schaub and Christopher Brooks

Ann Arbor, MI

Aug 2024 – Present

Zhejiang University

M.Ed. in Psychology, GPA 3.9/4.0

Hangzhou, China

Sep 2021 – Jun 2024

Southwest University

B.Sc. in Psychology, GPA 3.9/4.0

Chongqing, China

Sep 2017 – Jun 2021

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Research Assistant

University of Michigan, Security Privacy Interaction Lab

Aug 2024 – Present

Ann Arbor, MI

- Building an LLM privacy leakage benchmark and studying privacy risks in prompt-based interaction; designing human evaluation protocols for model outputs
- Co-led a mixed-methods survey study (N=260) of how university users trade off privacy, trust, and utility when adopting commercial vs. institutional AI assistants; published at CHI 2026, presented at SOUPS 2025
- Co-leading Hearing the Smile, a smart-glasses system for blind and low-vision users; ran interviews, surveys, and in-situ sessions, modeled survey and behavioral data in R, delivered design recommendations (CHI 2025 workshop)

Research Assistant

Johns Hopkins University, advised by Yaxing Yao

May 2022 – Aug 2024

Remote

- Designed and ran two vignette-based online experiments (N=867 and N=400) on tenants' privacy negotiation preferences for smart home devices in Airbnb; first-author papers at USENIX Security 2023 and 2026
- Owned survey and experiment design end to end: sampling and quota strategy on Prolific and MTurk, attention and data-quality checks
- Modeled preference data with mixed-effects regression in R; coded 8,000+ open-ended responses across two studies to identify negotiation strategies
- Produced design implications for in-platform negotiation tools and privacy disclosures; contributed to studies of voice interaction monitoring (USEC 2024) and AR for home privacy leaks (USEC 2023)

CONFERENCE PAPERS

[C.7] Exploring Privacy Negotiation Strategies for Camera-Equipped Smart Home Devices in Airbnb

Zixin Wang, Sunyup Park, Haojian Jin, and Yaxing Yao

35th USENIX Security Symposium (USENIX Security 2026)

[C.6] Privacy and Trust vs. Utility: Adoption of Commercial vs. Institutional AI Assistants Among University Users

Yuting Yang, Zixin Wang, Rongjun Ma, and Florian Schaub

Proceedings of the ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2026)

- [C.5] **Towards Real-Time Voice Interaction Data Collection Monitoring and Ambient Light Privacy Notification for Voice-Controlled Services**
 Tu Le, **Zixin Wang**, Danny Yuxing Huang, Yaxing Yao, and Yuan Tian
Symposium on Usable Security and Privacy (USEC 2024)
- [C.4] **Exploring Tenants' Preferences of Privacy Negotiation in Airbnb**
Zixin Wang, Danny Yuxing Huang, and Yaxing Yao
32nd USENIX Security Symposium (USENIX Security 2023)
- [C.3] **Augmented Reality's Potential for Identifying and Mitigating Home Privacy Leaks**
 Stefany Cruz, Logan Danek, Shinan Liu, Christopher Kraemer, **Zixin Wang**, Nick Feamster, Danny Yuxing Huang, Yaxing Yao, and Josiah Hester
Symposium on Usable Security and Privacy (USEC 2023)
- [C.2] **How We Express Ourselves Freely: Censorship, Self-Censorship, and Anti-Censorship on a Chinese Social Media**
 Xiang Chen, Jiamu Xie, **Zixin Wang**, Bohui Shen, and Zhixuan Zhou
18th iConference (iConference 2023)
- [C.1] **Anonymous Expression in an Online Community for Women in China**
 Zhixuan Zhou, **Zixin Wang**, and Franziska Zimmer
56th Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS 2023)

JOURNAL PAPERS

- [J.1] **Energy Demand Unawareness and the Popularity of Bitcoin: Evidence from Nigeria**
 Moritz Platt, Stephen Ojeka, Andreea-Elena Drăgnoiu, Oserere Ejemen Ibelegbu, Francesco Pierangeli, Johannes Sedlmeir, and **Zixin Wang**
Oxford Open Energy, 2023

WORKSHOP PAPERS

- [W.2] **Hearing the Smile: Scoring Spontaneous Social Scenes for the Visually Impaired**
 Shan Luo, **Zixin Wang**, and Botao Hu
ACM CHI 2025 Workshop on Affective Interaction and Affective Computing: Past, Present, and Future
- [W.1] **The More You Know: Energy Labelling Enables More Sustainable Cryptocurrency Investments**
 Andreea-Elena Drăgnoiu, Moritz Platt, **Zixin Wang**, and Zhixuan Zhou
IEEE ICDCS 2023 Workshop on Fintech and Decentralized Finance (FiDeFix)

POSTERS AND EXTENDED ABSTRACTS

- [P.2] **TunTun Diary: Exploring AI-Generated Storytelling and Virtual Companionship for Nightmare Relief**
Zixin Wang, Shan Luo, Siyu Tian, Yunxi Cai, Long Ling, Muhan Xu, Jiaxing Yu, Guanting Lu, Jiajing Zhu, and Liping Luo
Proceedings of the SIGGRAPH Asia 2025, Poster Session
- [P.1] **Privacy Perceptions in the Use of ChatGPT Across Different Contexts: A Survey Study of Commercial vs. University-Specific Implementations**
 Yuting Yang, **Zixin Wang**, and Florian Schaub
Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS 2025), Poster Session

TEACHING

Graduate Student Instructor, SI 544 Introduction to Statistics and Data Analysis, University of Michigan, Fall 2026

SELECTED HONORS

Rackham Graduate Student Research Grant (\$1,500), <i>University of Michigan</i>	2025
Ph.D. Incentive Research Fund (\$4,000), <i>University of Michigan, School of Information</i>	2024
Ph.D. Fellowship, <i>University of Michigan, School of Information</i>	2024
Student Grant, <i>USENIX Security Symposium, USENIX Association</i>	2026
National Scholarship, <i>Ministry of Education of China</i>	2020

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Conference Reviewer

CHI 2023–2026; CSCW 2024; CHI PLAY 2026; L@S 2026; IMX 2024; iConference 2025–2026; HICSS 2023, 2025

Journal Reviewer

Information, Communication and Society (2026)